



THE ROYAL AFFAIR CORNER

FEATURING PROFESSIONAL PHOTOGRAPHER

Gcina Mdlomo Mtungwa



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Lets us know about the man behind the lens. Who is he ?

He is a self taught professional photographer driven by creativity and curiosity. Funny,smart and uptight.

Tell us of a childhood memory you have with a camera?

When I was a toddler I had no fear for cameras and strangers. One day my elder brother and I aged 5 and 3 were taken to a photo studio in the evening. In an unfamiliar space, less ambient lighting, I saw a stranger aiming something at us through his eye, and I was frightened and ran away shouting Bayangidubula, bayangidubula. The results is a solo picture of my brother which is proof that is were being shot but not with a gun

What feeling does the camera ignite in you ?

It actually brings a mindset of greater responsibility whereby I'm assigned with trust or doubt, to document that one decisive moment by pressing the shutter button which tends to be a great picture.

When did you get your own first camera ? Take us through that moment.

Its Canon PowerShot A580, now kept as an antique, which was sponsored by my eldest brother in 2009. I pitched my idea to him. I saw a potential in the photography business while employed within hard manual labour and toxic working environment.

You have made amazing progress in your photography career and becoming a household brand . How long have you been in the industry and what can you say have been valuable lessons in the building process ?

A duration of 14 years split in to two, the first 4 years as an amateur plus 10 years of professional experience in business. I haven't learnt to adapt to changes; a certain percentage deem photography business as dying due to camera phones. Business marketing techniques and human lifestyle has improved much in the 21st century, which gives more photography opportunities on both personal and business level.

Great building also needs persistence, its a lengthy time of grinding which may be beyond your expectations and calculations.



Take us back to your ever professional gig, how was it and who the gig was for?

I value all gigs done as unique. I would like to pin Bongi and Promise Ceko's wedding documented in October 2014. With one year of professional experience by then, its about the trust put on me. We stretched to the greatest potential by doing DIY equipment accessories and using two of our home TVs for displaying our video feed. We gave more pre-production and we were given trust. At nine years of their marriage, I was assigned to photograph their pregnancy photo shoot in the studio.



What is the 2023 vision that you have for Gcina media ?

We are on a 10 years anniversary mark. We have advanced technically and need to improve on business conduct.

Our focus is investing to grow in video production to greater standards. I see gaps to be specifically filled and filmed in our plan

How do you aim to inspire the youth out there as a professional photographer?

Working on gradual growth which should turn into a renown and stable brand will put more inspiration to others just like reflect from local and international creatives.

What words of wisdom do you have for young Gcina ?

Be passionate, persistent and progress I've. Keep learning and aim beyond the well known boundaries. In the photography field and in the creative industry as a whole, the opportunities are so endless.

SNAP AHEAD...



You have tremendously grown your client base in Mpumalanga. Which events that you were booked for would you say have been career changing ?

Capturing Mpumalanga provinces prestigious events is always part of my learning curve and an exercise of consistency and improvement. Its also an honor to be trusted by big brands. I would like to put the Mpumalanga Gospel Music Awards on the spotlight. I was given a chance to photograph the event with no related experience and with years driven with passion, forged my skills to document similar events. Its an event brand founded the same year with our company.

Ndalo Group of Hotels has also given me a room for growth in the genre of real estate photography. They are a brand who would have chose amongst a pool of the most experienced and reputable but chose to nurture an enthusiast into a professional. I would like to thank everyone for the endless support, I value your trust, love, loyalty and financial seeding. More to living



“Education is an admirable thing, but it is well to remember from time to time that nothing that is worth knowing can be taught.”

Oscar Wilde